STATE SCAN

BENGAL: MINORITY REPORT *PG 22* **GUJARAT: GREEN POWER VS GREEN POWER** *PG 24*



WINNING QUARTERS Abhijit Wanjarri (Congress, Nagpur); inset, from top, Lal Bihari Yadav (SP, Varanasi), Sanjeev Kumar Singh (RJD, Patna), S.V. Sankanur (BJP, West Graduates' Constituency, Karnataka)

▶ UP, MAHARASHTRA, KARNATAKA, BIHAR

WARNING FROM THE BALLOTS

Legislative council elections were perhaps never watched so closely. But four states leave some questions—written on ballot paper—for the BJP

By **Anilesh S. Mahajan**

THE COUNTING IN THE NAGPUR DIVISION GRADUATES seat ran for over a tense 40 hours. The sitting Congress MLC, Abhijit Wanjarri, led by 927 votes on first preferences. Once transfers began, the BJP's Sudhakar Kohale went ahead by about 4,300 votes after round two, and stayed in that zone for much of the count. The gap closed as later preferences were transferred. Late on October 28, with counting still on, Kohale conceded. "I congratulate them," he told media. Wanjarri was declared winner early on October 29, by 3,271 votes. The cliffhanger, and how it swung, expressed a general truth.

The previous evening, with Nagpur still on the line, Prime Minister Narendra Modi had posted on X that elections had been held for 28 legislative council seats in four states, and asked how many the Congress had won. A rhetorical jab. For, at that point, the answer was zero.